

World Cup Alpha — Current Favourites (2026-06-18)

28 fixtures played (Groups A-B round 2 included)

WC26 Winner — Three Weightings

#	Model (w=1.0)	Market-Anchored (w=0.5)	Market Only (w=0.0)
1	Argentina 17.8%	Spain 15.2%	France 18.0%
2	Spain 16.1%	France 14.6%	Spain 13.3%
3	France 11.6%	Argentina 14.4%	England 12.6%
4	England 9.8%	England 11.2%	Argentina 11.5%
5	Brazil 9.7%	Brazil 8.2%	Portugal 7.2%
6	Colombia 5.8%	Portugal 5.6%	Brazil 6.5%

Correction from round 1: Spain now leads the market-anchored blend. Groups A & B round-2 results have altered the trajectory — groups are tightening and Argentina's model dominance fades when anchored to market prices. France holds steady as the second favourite across all three weightings.

Polymarket Group Winner Edges

Top 12 opportunities | Model: P(Advance) per team, normalized within group | Market: de-vigged bid/ask midpoints

1. Jordan (Group J)	+1098%	Mkt 663.67 → Fair 55.41
2. Algeria (Group J)	+920%	Mkt 71.11 → Fair 6.97
3. Senegal (Group I)	+861%	Mkt 60.48 → Fair 6.30
4. Croatia (Group L)	+761%	Mkt 30.21 → Fair 3.51
5. Ecuador (Group E)	+638%	Mkt 28.20 → Fair 3.82
6. Cape Verde (Group H)	+201%	Mkt 37.85 → Fair 12.56
7. Iran (Group G)	+213%	Mkt 13.52 → Fair 4.32
8. Ghana (Group L)	+149%	Mkt 23.00 → Fair 9.22
9. Paraguay (Group D)	+421%	Mkt 49.41 → Fair 9.48
10. Tunisia (Group F)	+118%	Mkt 112.67 → Fair 51.60
11. Uzbekistan (Group K)	+550%	Mkt 134.60 → Fair 20.70
12. Iraq (Group I)	+686%	Mkt 665.33 → Fair 84.63

Minnow undervaluation: Long-odds teams (odds >30) show massive edges because the model's group-winner probability (via P(Advance) proxy) is near-zero, while Polymarket prices them at 500:1+. Liquidity varies — prefer mid-tier edges (Cape Verde, Iran, Ecuador) with tighter bid/ask. Extreme edges >500% likely have thin liquidity.